

The Water Cycle — Answer Key

Weather and Water • Level 3

A. Match each water-cycle word to its meaning.

1. evaporation

Answer: water changes into water vapour

2. condensation

Answer: water vapour cools into tiny droplets

3. precipitation

Answer: water falls from clouds as rain or snow

4. collection

Answer: water gathers in rivers, lakes and oceans

B. Circle the best answer.

1. The Sun heats water and it turns to vapour — evaporation, precipitation, or collection?

Answer: evaporation

2. Clouds form from cooled water vapour — collection, condensation, or rainfall?

Answer: condensation

3. Rain, snow or hail falling from clouds — precipitation, evaporation, or sunlight?

Answer: precipitation

4. Water gathering in the sea, lakes or rivers — condensation, collection, or freezing?

Answer: collection

C. Fill in the blanks (word bank: sun, evaporation, condensation, precipitation, collection).

1. The _____ gives energy to start the water cycle.

Answer: sun

2. Water changing into vapour is called _____.

Answer: evaporation

3. Clouds form during _____.

Answer: condensation

4. Rain falling from clouds is _____.

Answer: precipitation

5. Water gathers again during _____.

Answer: collection

D. How does the water cycle help Earth?

Answer: It moves the same water around Earth again and again, so living things always have water to drink and use — evaporation and condensation form clouds that bring rain to plants, animals and people, then collection gathers the water so the cycle can start again.